Levi Skye Morris

Staff / Principal Engineer | Payments, Data & Platform Systems | Former CTO
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SUMMARY

Hands-on staff/principal engineer and former CTO with 11+ years building ledgers, payment gateways and compliant distributed systems for sensitive financial and health data. Led the rebuild of a high-risk payments platform and kept it at 99.9% uptime through banking loss, deplatforming and persistent attacks.

Core stack: TypeScript, Python, Java, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Django, NestJS, AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Terraform

EXPERIENCE

SpankChain | Remote
Chief Technology Officer / Principal Engineer | Jul 2020–Apr 2026
Acting Head of Engineering | Dec 2019–Jul 2020
Senior Software Engineer | Apr 2019–Dec 2019
High-risk payment processor for independent creators with its own ledger, KYC/AML and crypto plus fiat settlement rails.

- Architected and led the rebuild of SpankPay v2, the company's ledger and payments platform, storing an opening balance on every transaction for fast, auditable balances.
- Kept balances correct under concurrent writes with explicit locks and serializable transactions; planned hot-account splitting and migrated balances via snapshot and backfill.
- Secured payment infrastructure and signing keys against persistent, well-resourced attackers, with most funds held cold so no exploit could threaten solvency.
- Architected SpankPay.me, keeping independent creators paid after mainstream processors deplatformed them.
- Maintained 99.9% uptime through the loss of banking partners and deplatforming; retained about 80% of the core team through a product sunset.
- Led 8–10 engineers across five countries plus a contracted team; mentored a bootcamp hire into a production backend engineer within four months.

CampSpot | Denver, Colorado
Senior Software Engineer | Sep 2017–Feb 2019

- Led a three-person payments team; built a PCI DSS Level 1 payment gateway with AES-256 encryption of cardholder data.
- Built reservation and payment systems in Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Node.js and React on AWS.

DocNetwork / CampDoc | Ann Arbor, Michigan
Development Team Lead | Aug 2015–Jun 2017

- Led a 3–5-person team building a HIPAA/FERPA-compliant health record platform on Node.js, PostgreSQL and AWS.
- Resolved severe PostgreSQL bottlenecks (query plans, indexing, recursive CTEs) as monthly payment volume grew from six to seven figures.

SearchSpring | Colorado Springs, Colorado
Integration Specialist | Nov 2014–Aug 2015

- Built e-commerce search integrations for Shopify, Magento, NetSuite and BigCommerce, indexing catalog data into Elasticsearch.

Gelada Research Project | Simien Mountains, Ethiopia
Field Site Manager | Jun 2012–Jan 2014

- Ran a remote, high-altitude primate research station; extended its Palm Pilot data-collection software with no prior programming experience.

PROJECTS

WUIXpose | 2026
Open source: Django, PostGIS, React

- Maps home ignition zones around every structure in Boulder County, served as PostGIS vector tiles to a MapLibre frontend.
- Keeps incremental jobs correct with database triggers that track geometry changes.

Computational ecology | 2026

- Ricker and stochastic eco-evolutionary models in Clojure and Python with bifurcation and Lyapunov analysis.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Clojure, Python, SQL, Solidity, Vyper, R

Product and web: React, NextJS, Node.js, NestJS, Django, Express, Dropwizard, REST, GraphQL

Data: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, MongoDB

Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, EKS, Lambda, RDS, S3, KMS); GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, BigQuery, Pub/Sub); Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions

AI and agentic systems: Claude Code, Codex, Qwen Code and OpenCode run in parallel with repo-level agent instructions and CI/pre-commit guardrails; LiteLLM routing to local Qwen and Gemma models

Security and cryptography: AES-256 field-level encryption, key management, digital signatures, Keycloak

Risk and compliance: PCI DSS Level 1, HIPAA, FERPA, KYC/AML, GDPR/CCPA

EDUCATION

University of Michigan | Bachelor of Science | 2012

National Science Foundation | Graduate Research Fellowship Program, Honorable Mention | 2014